



Leave Policy

POLICY

As part of our commitment to enhancing employee wellness and engagement in the workplace, we have outlined the following leave categories to help us achieve our goal.

ELIGIBILITY

The procedures governing each leave policy type are included at the end of each policy and the general responsibilities are included at the end of this policy.

The policy set out in this document applies to all permanent employees of GRG. This policy covers the following types of leave:

- Annual Leave
- Sick Leave
- Maternity Leave
- Paternity Leave
- Parental Leave
- Compassionate/Bereavement Leave
- Umrah/Hajj Leave
- Religious Leave
- Study Leave



ANNUAL LEAVE

Principles

Annual Leave Entitlement

Leave entitlement forms part of each employee's remuneration package and is accrued monthly. Each employee is entitled to 22 working days leave per year.

The annual leave cycle runs from 1 January to 31 December.

Annual leave entitlement may be taken only at a time agreed between the employee and their direct line manager. Prior approval is always required.

Leave will be determined within each team, considering planned requirements and individual preferences. However, the final decision on the allocation of leave dates will be determined by business needs.

Application to take leave before it is accrued needs to be emailed and approved by the respective Line Manager and then submitted to HR for record keeping.

The period of annual leave should not be taken concurrently with sick leave.

Accumulation of Annual Leave

Employees are expected to take their annual leave entitlement during the annual leave cycle – calendar year (January to December).

Any annual leave not taken will not be transferrable to the following year. This is due to the flexible office hours and work from home/anywhere policy of GRG. If however the individual has not been able to take leave during a particular calendar year due to business commitments, the relevant director may request approval for carryover to the following year from HR.

Under no circumstances can employees be paid for annual leave not taken.



Annual Leave and Termination of Employment

Employees may request to take annual leave during their notice period (once their manager has received the notification of resignation). It is, however, at management 's discretion whether to grant the leave or not.

Should an employee have outstanding leave when they exit the business, their outstanding leave days will be paid out as part of their last salary payment. Leave days due will be calculated on a full calendar month's service completed. The leave pay is calculated on basic salary excluding annual bonus, commission, or allowances. Outstanding leave to a maximum of your annual leave entitlement (22 working days) will be paid out.

Annual leave taken more than accrued entitlement will be deducted from final payments made.

Unpaid Leave

Application for unpaid leave needs to be made in writing and authorized by the Managing Director of GRG. Granting of unpaid leave is at Management's discretion and each application will be considered on its individual merits.

Procedure

- Leave should be discussed and then authorized via email by the direct Line Manager
- Approval email should be shared with HR for record purposes.
- The following conditions of leave should be adhered to when applying:
 - 1 day in advance for a day's leave,
 - 1 week in advance for 2-4 working days leave,
 - 1 month in advance for 5-10 working days leave,
 - 2 months in advance for 11 working days and more



SICK LEAVE

Principles

Sick Leave Entitlement

The sick leave cycle runs annually from January to December each year. Each employee who joins GRG will be entitled to 90 days sick leave per yearly cycle. If an employee joins GRG during the cycle the number of days entitled will be pro-rata.

Payment for sick leave will be as follows:

- First 15 days = full pay
- Next 30 days = half pay
- Next 45 days = no pay

Sick leave will only be entitled to permanent employees of GRG. During the employee probation period no sick leave will be entitled to the employee, only at management's discretion.

Leave can be taken anytime during the yearly cycle, but once the sick leave days have been depleted then the employee will have no further sick leave available within the cycle.

If an employee is medically diagnosed with a mental health illness and is booked off for this, it will be considered as sick leave.

If an employee has been medically diagnosed with a menstrual period condition that would require the employee to take time off each month, it will be considered as sick leave.

Sick Leave Authorisation

In all cases the employee must inform their direct manager of their absence on the first day of absence from work, this also includes time off for a few hours of rest due to being ill.

All employees who are off for two consecutive days must provide a valid medical certificate from a medical entity.

If there is no valid medical certificate produced the sick leave may be captured as annual or unpaid leave, at managements discretion.



Application for Additional Sick Leave

In cases where the maximum sick leave benefit applicable to the employee has been reached, the employee will be encouraged to use their annual leave benefit. Once the sick and annual leave applicable has both been reached, employees with serious medical conditions should apply for a discretionary temporary increase in sick leave or to be temporary placed on sabbatical due to incapacity.

Any application for increased sick leave should be made in writing to the managing director of GRG. The application should be supported by a full official medical report. GRG has the right to recommend their own medical professional to assess the employee's medical condition based on the application provided. GRG's decision is discretionary and may or may not result in increased sick leave granted to the employee.

Unused Sick Leave

Any sick leave not taken at the end of the leave cycle falls away and the next cycle commences with the fresh allocation of 90 days.

Procedure

The employee needs to notify their line manager the morning of their impending absence, even if the absence is for half a day's (few hours) sick leave.

If the employee requires more than 2 day's sick leave a valid medical script needs to be produced within 48 hours of return to work.

The line manager of the concerned employee is responsible for ensuring all documentation is received and procedure is followed.



MATERNITY LEAVE

Principles

Maternity Leave Entitlement

All female employees in permanent positions at GRG would be entitled to maternity leave. This also includes pregnant employees and employees adopting a child, who will be the primary caregiver. In the case of adoption, the child should be under the age of 2 years for the parent to qualify for this benefit.

This leave policy supports the following principles:

- Our policies and benefits support our approach to ensuring that we attract, engage, and retain top talent from diverse backgrounds.
- Progressing our diversity and inclusion strategy is a key business imperative and attracting and retaining female talent is vital to achieving targets.
- We believe in cultivating a culture that embraces diversity and inclusiveness. We, therefore, will not tolerate discrimination of any kind during or after pregnancy. Women who wish to continue working for GRG after taking maternity leave should be encouraged to do so. We believe that by enabling each employee to combine their work optimally and effectively with their other aspirations and responsibilities, we can leverage the diverse talent of our workforce for individual, team and organizational success.
- Maternity / Adoption leave benefits are linked to length of service and specific individual contractual terms and conditions.
- All employees will be required to work for at least the equivalent of the maternity /adoption leave taken after returning to work.

Employees with more than 6 months service at GRG will be entitled to 60 days maternity leave of which:

- 45 days will be fully paid leave,
- 15 days will be half-paid leave.

During the period of absence for maternity leave; it will be considered as continuous employment for the purpose of:

- Date of employment
- Annual leave
- Sick leave



In addition to the basic maternity leave above, the employee may take an additional 45 days without pay if the employee has an illness because of pregnancy or childbirth and is unable to resume work. The illness must be proved via a medical certificate issued from the respective medical authority. These leave days can be consecutive or intermittent.

If the baby is sick or suffers from a disability, the employee may take additional leave of 30 days fully paid. This leave can be extended for additional 30 days without pay. The illness or the disability of the child must be proved via a medical certificate issued from the respective medical authority.

After the employee resumes work, she would be entitled to one or two additional breaks each day for nursing her child. The duration of the two breaks must not exceed one hour. The employee would be entitled to such breaks for 6 months following the date of delivery. Such breaks are fully paid for.

Payment of Salary and Benefits

The compensation and benefits that you are eligible for according to this policy will be paid into your bank account monthly, on the 27th day of the month. This applies to all salaried employees. No loans or advanced salary will be granted by GRG to cover any personal costs associated with pregnancy and / or maternity / adoption leave.

Commencement

You may commence maternity / adoption leave from four weeks before the expected date of birth, unless otherwise agreed, or on a date as certified by a medical practitioner or a midwife. Your maternity benefit starts from the actual date you officially go on maternity leave.

Should a pregnant employee be booked off by a doctor, the employee will proceed on maternity leave from that date and will not return to work prior to six weeks after the birth of the baby or as indicated by the doctor.

An employee who has a miscarriage during the third trimester of pregnancy or bears a stillborn child is entitled to maternity leave for six weeks after the miscarriage or stillbirth, whether or not the employee has commenced maternity leave at the time of the miscarriage or stillbirth.



Return to Work

If you intend to return earlier than stipulated and agreed on in your leave application, please give reasonable notice for your manager to relieve nonpermanent employees or make the necessary arrangements to accommodate your request.

No employee may work during the first six weeks after the birth of their child unless a medical practitioner or midwife certifies that they are fit to do so.

Returning employees will be placed in the same or similar job, upon their return from maternity / adoption leave.

If you worked full-time prior to your maternity / adoption leave, you have no automatic right to return to work on a part-time basis or to make other changes to your working patterns. However, all requests for part-time work or other flexible working arrangements will be considered in line with the operational requirements of the business and will require authorization by the managing director and HR. This is aligned to an effective work-life management approach.

Health and Safety

GRG agrees that pregnant women shall not be given any task that may endanger themselves or their unborn child. Furthermore, permission shall not be unreasonably withheld for an employee to take time off for medical attention for herself during her pregnancy. Such periods of absence will be regarded as sick leave and depending on the amount of time off required; should be accompanied by a doctor's note.

Working during Maternity / Adoption Leave

If your job requires that you come into the office or go on a business trip during your maternity leave period, your line manager needs to authorize that you can take the time worked as leave at an agreed later date (or possibly extend your maternity / adoption leave).

Time off for Ante-natal Care

You are entitled to reasonable time off with pay to attend antenatal clinics or to visit your doctor if it is associated with your pregnancy. You should request time off in advance and should produce your appointment confirmation if asked to do so.



Performance Development Review

If your review is due to take place while you are on maternity / adoption leave, you and your line manager should carry it out before you leave. This will take the place of your annual review and half year review.

Procedure

The employee is encouraged to inform their line manager and HR about the pregnancy as soon as possible. This is important, as there are health and safety considerations for both them and GRG.

The employee is required apply for maternity leave form at least two months prior to taking the maternity leave, noting:

- The expected week of childbirth / or adoption,
- The date on which the employee intends to start the maternity leave and,
- The date the employee intends to return to work.

Please note if any of the above information changes, the employee will need to consult their line manager immediately.

In the case of adoption, the employee needs to give one month's notice of the expected week of placement or the start of the period of introductions to the child / children. In rare cases where this is not possible, an adoptive parent should give the notice as soon as is reasonably practicable. The line manager may ask to see evidence to confirm the employee is the parent or the person who is legally responsible for the child.

Application for Additional Maternity / Adoption Leave

GRG is willing to engage with and explore options with employees who may need additional maternity leave and / or more flexibility on their return to work. A formal discussion with line manager and HR needs to be engaged as soon as the employee understands the amount of time required.



PATERNITY LEAVE

Principles

This leave applies to all employees with more than 6 months confirmed employment who, with their spouse or partner, is responsible for the upbringing of a child.

Paternity Leave Entitlement

Paternity leave of 5 working days will be granted to employees from the day their child is born or date their adopted child comes home up to 6 months. The rate of pay of paternity leave will be 100% of Cost to Company (CTC) salary.

Procedure

In the case of birth paternity leave, during or before the 15th week before the expected date of arrival, the employee should inform their line manager of the expected birth date of the child and their proposed dates of absence.

In the case of 'adoption paternity leave', the employee should inform their line manager no more than 7 days after the employee is notified of matching with the child or, where this is not reasonably practicable, as soon as it is reasonably practicable of their proposed dates of absence.

The employee should apply for leave and receive their line manager's approval.



PARENTAL LEAVE

Principles

Parental Leave Entitlement

All full-time employees at GRG will be entitled to 5 working days of parental leave per year from the day their child is born or date their adopted child comes home.

Parental leave will be granted for both the mother of the child or the father of the child; in cases where their child is sick.

Procedure

The employee needs to notify their line manager the morning of their impending absence, even if the absence is for half a day's (few hours) leave.

If the employee requires more than 2 day's consecutive parental leave a valid medical script needs to be produced within 48 hours of return to work confirming the child's illness.

The line manager of the concerned employee is responsible for ensuring all documentation is received and procedure is followed.



COMPASSIONATE/ BEREAVEMENT LEAVE

Principles

Compassionate/Bereavement Leave Entitlement

A maximum of 5 working days paid leave per annum will be granted for compassionate/bereavement leave for the death of wife or husband.

A maximum of 3 working days paid leave per annum will be granted for compassionate/bereavement leave for the death of mother, father, son, daughter, sibling, and grandparents.

Procedure

Employees need to inform their line manager as soon as possible about their absence, the reason for it and how long they expect to be away from work.

A copy of the death certificate needs to be submitted once the employee returns to work.



HAJJ AND UMRAH LEAVE

Principles

Hajj Leave Entitlement

Employees may be granted a special leave for the performance of Hajj under the provisions that the leave:

- is given without pay,
- may not exceed 30 days,
- is granted only once during the employment duration with the company.

Umrah Leave Entitlement

The UAE Labour Law does not have any provisions which entitle the employee for Umrah leave. If an employee of GRG requests leave, for Umrah, this will be considered annual leave or unpaid leave after leave is applied for.

Procedure

Employees wanting to apply for leave for Hajj or Umrah should request such leave in accordance with the annual leave timelines and get approval from both line manager and HR.



RELIGIOUS LEAVE

Principles

Religious Leave Entitlement

We recognise that the UAE public holiday calendar does not include non-Muslim religious holidays, therefore all other colleagues following a recognised religion will be entitled to 2 days additional paid religious leave to be taken on acknowledged religious holidays, for example, Christmas, Easter, Passover, Diwali, etc.

Procedure

Employees wanting to apply religious leave should request such leave in accordance with the annual leave timelines and get approval from line manager.



STUDY LEAVE

Principles

Study Leave Entitlement

Employees who have completed at least two years of service with GRG, are entitled to 10 days paid leave per year to sit for examinations or study for examinations.

Procedure

Employee must apply for study leave approval from line manager by requesting days required coupled with the examination schedule and confirmation of being a student at the institution.